DAL 1877

Barilla®

FINAL CASE



ACADEMIA BARILLA

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01 Issue Statement

Academia Barilla (AB) remains niche and underscaled in the U.S. market because it is not effectively educating high-income consumers about its authentic Italian products.

02 Situational Analysis

The Business Model Canvas and STP models are chosen for the situational analysis because they work well together to examine AB's strategic challenges. The Business Model Canvas shows how AB creates and delivers value through its artisanal sourcing, educational activities, gourmet channels, and premium product design, while also pointing out the structural weaknesses such as high costs, limited distribution, and dependency on chef-led education. To complement it, the STP model addresses the core issue of identifying and targeting the right high-income U.S. consumers. It clarifies which segments value authentic Italian food, how AB should target them, and how they should position themselves in a way that is both premium and accessible. Together, these models analyzes the gaps between what AB offers and how the U.S. market understands it, helping to explain why the brand remains niche and unable to effectively educate or reach its intended audience.

Business Model Canvas

Key Partners

- Small artisanal PDO/DOP producers of olive oil, balsamic vinegar, cheeses, and cured meats
- Italian culinary institutions that support legitimacy and education
- Chefs & gastronomy experts who participate in tastings, educational events, and product endorsements
- Specialty & gourmet retailers in major U.S. metropolitan areas (NYC, Boston, Chicago, LA, etc.).
- Barilla Group for financial backing, organizational infrastructure, and brand credibility

Key Activities

- Selecting and sourcing top-quality PDO products through strict taste panels, producer visits, and quality criteria
- Culinary education & training through Italian Culinary Specialists (ICS), chef training, and tastings
- Managing the Academia Barilla Culinary Center for labs, demonstrations, and training sessions
- Product packaging focused on regional authenticity and premium design

Key Resources

- Network of PDO artisanal producers across Italy
- ICS serving as educators and product ambassadors
- Academia Barilla Culinary Center
- Gastronomic library supporting content and culinary authority
- Brand equity tied to authenticity, quality, and Italian culinary heritage

Value propositions

- Authentic, premium, region-specific Italian foods sourced from the best PDO/DOP producers
- Guaranteed product excellence through rigorous quality selection, tastings, and expert process
- Culinary education and cultural immersion through courses, demos, chef training, Parma center
- A gastronomic experience, not just a product, as it combines the story, origin, and Italian tradition
- An authoritative source for real Italian cuisine, differentiating from mass-market Italian brands that currently exist in the U.S.

Customer Relationships

- Chef and retailer education via ICS
- Experiential learning through classes, demos, and culinary center programs
- Personalized support to restaurants such as training chefs and teaching proper product usage
- Cultural relationship-building emphasizing tradition, heritage, and authenticity rather than transactional sales

Channels

- Gourmet and specialty food retailers in U.S. markets
- High-end restaurants receiving ICS demonstrations and product education.
- Academia Barilla Culinary Center as an educational hub
- Online platform providing product information, recipes, and online ordering

Customer Segments

- U.S. consumers interested in gourmet and artisanal foods
- Food enthusiasts, home cooks, and culinary hobbyists seeking authentic Italian experiences
- Chefs and restaurant professionals who value premium ingredients and culinary heritage
- Gourmet retailers wanting differentiated, high-quality Italian imports
- Tourists and culinary students participating in courses at the Parma center
- High Income families dining out or looking for a high-quality Italian experience

Cost

- High cost of small-batch PDO sourcing
- Extensive ICS labor costs (ex. training, travel, demos).
- Operation of the Culinary Center (ex. labs, staff, events).
- Premium packaging and quality control processes
- Complex, multi-channel distribution across the U.S.
- R&D and product selection (ex. tasting panels, ingridient analyses)

Revenue Streams

- Sales of premium artisanal food products (ex. olive oils, vinegars, cheeses, cured meats)
- Foodservice sales to high-end restaurants
- Retail sales via gourmet stores
- Culinary center revenues: cooking classes, training fees, team-building sessions
- Publishing and content revenues (ex. cookbooks, guides)
- Special events and partnerships

Key Takeaways/ Connections to Issue Statement

The Business Model Canvas reveals that AB's strategy is based in high-quality sourcing, cultural authority, and education-driven consumer engagement, but this model also limits scalability and market reach. Its strengths, such as premium DOP-certified products, partnerships with chefs, experiential learning, and strong brand credibility, appeal to a narrow segment of authenticity-seeking consumers. However, the heavy reliance on labor-intensive activities such as tastings, classes, chef demos, small-batch production, and limited specialty channels leads to high operating costs and restricted distribution, preventing the brand from unlocking broader demand in the U.S. market. The canvas reveals an imbalance: while the value proposition depends on storytelling and education, the current channels and customer relationships are too high-touch to deliver at a large scale. This implies a for strategy, that AB must adopt more scalable, and widely accessible education channels if it hopes to move beyond its niche market, and improve long-term profitability without compromising authenticity.

STP

Segmentation

Academia Barilla segments the U.S. market primarily by geography and culinary interest. Demand for Italian cuisine is highest in major areas such as New York, Boston, and Chicago, which have the largest concentrations of Italian restaurants and gourmet food stores. Within these regions, AB further segments consumers by their interest in premium, culturally rooted food experiences, such as individuals who attend tastings, visit culinary centers, and read gourmet magazines. Overall, AB segment based on location and engagement with high-end gastronomy, with more focus on higher income populations who are willing to buy their products. This segmentation ties to the issue statement as AB focuses on markets with high-income, food-engaged consumers but still struggles to educate them effectively, leaving these segments underdeveloped.

Targeting

Academia Barilla targets specific groups within those segmented markets, focusing on U.S. chefs, gourmet retailers, and culinary professionals who influence consumer purchasing. This is reflected in the ICS program, which prioritizes restaurants and specialty stores that can showcase AB products through demonstrations, training, and chef education. AB also targets consumers who actively seek deeper culinary knowledge by offering classes and programs at the Parma Culinary Center. The targeting strategy therefore concentrates on learners who can amplify AB's presence and adopt its products in professional or educational settings. The connection to the issue statement is that AB's targeting relies on high-touch, labor-intensive educational interactions, which limits the their ability to reach a broader base of high-income U.S. consumers at a large scale.

Positioning

Academia Barilla positions itself as the ambassador of authentic Italian gastronomy, distinguished by its rigorous product selection process and cultural credentials. The brand highlights workmanship, PDO regional distinctiveness, and commitment to traditional Italian culinary heritage, distinguishing itself from conventional Italian food brands that prioritize convenience, efficiency, or cost. Through media coverage and partnerships with culinary institutions, AB positions its offering as a premium, culturally grounded experience that meet the standards of high-income groups in the U.S. This positioning links to the issue statement because although AB stands for authenticity and education, it has not successfully communicated this value to high-income consumers, resulting in a niche perception and limited market penetration.

Key Takeaways/ Connections to Issue Statement

The STP analysis indicates that Academia Barilla targets the appropriate demographic of affluent, food-oriented consumers in prominent U.S. cities; yet, its strategy is excessively dependent on chef-focused, labor-intensive instruction and specialized culinary avenues. While AB segments and targets markets with strong demand for premium Italian cuisine, its message fails to connect with ordinary consumers who do not recognize the significance of PDO distinctions. Together, these insights reinforce the issue statement that AB remains niche and underscaled as it has failed to identify an effective, scalable method to inform high-income U.S. consumers about the authenticity and value of its premium and authentic offerings.

03 Decision Criteria

Market Reach & Scalability — 30%

This criterion evaluates how effectively each strategy expands AB's access to it targeted high-income U.S. consumers. It considers the number of people reached and whether education can scale beyond physical locations.

Reason for weight: Market reach is the biggest issue faced by AB at this point.

Consumer Education Effectiveness — 20%

This criterion evaluates the degree to which consumers are educated in areas related to authentic Italian gastronomic culture, DOP certifications, and ingredient quality.

Reason for weight: The issue statement identifies consumer education gap as an essential barrier, and is the main issue that AB tackles in 2006.

Cost & Operational Complexity — 15%

This criterion examines investment costs and ongoing operating costs (staffing, logistics, events, partnerships), as well as implementation difficulty. Strategies that require fewer resources and have lower complexity score higher.

Reason for weight: AB is small with limited budgets, thus maintaining a low operating budget is crucial.

Brand Image Elevation — 15%

This criterion assesses how each strategy strengthens AB's brand image, prestige, and premium positioning. Options that reinforce Italian heritage score higher.

Reason for weight: AB must maintain a premium identity.

Long-Term Profitability — 10%

This criterion measures whether the strategy can generate sustained revenue growth through consistent product demand, brand loyalty, and increased purchase frequency.

Reason for weight: AB needs long term profits to sustain its operations, but it is not the major problem it is dealing with right now.

Differentiation & Competitive Advantage — 10%

This criterion evaluates how much the strategy makes AB stand out from generic Italian brands or substitutes. Unique partnerships or proprietary educational content score highly.

Reason for weight: AB needs to differentiate itself to escape niche status, however, this is secondary to reach and education.

Explanation for Weights

The weights allocated above prioritize the criteria that most directly solve the two core issues in the issue statement: limited reach and inability to educate the mass market. Market Reach (30%) and Education Effectiveness (20%) together form half of the total weight, reflecting their central importance. Cost and Brand Image each receive meaningful but smaller weights because AB must remain premium while managing resource constraints. Profitability and Differentiation are important but not as urgent, so they are weighted more lightly.

04 Alternatives

Status Quo - Alternative 1

Under the status quo, AB continue to operate as a small, premium, education-driven niche brand focused on promoting Italian gastronomic culture through chef training, tastings, and experiential marketing. The company maintains its emphasis on artisanal sourcing, DOP-certified products, and high-touch culinary education delivered through Italian Culinary Specialists (ICS) and the Parma Culinary Center. Distribution would remain limited to select gourmet stores and high-end Italian restaurants in major U.S. cities, ensuring controlled quality and preserving the brand's exclusivity. Revenues would continue to come from selling premium oils, vinegars, cheeses, and cured meats, along with fees from culinary classes and events.

This status quo approach leverages AB's strengths, including its authenticity, cultural authority, and educational depth while avoiding the risks and costs of scaling into mainstream markets. It preserves the brand's identity and ensures product integrity by keeping sourcing selective and educational activities personalized. Remaining in this model means that AB will stay as a small, slow-growing company, and will still be largely dependent on chef-driven awareness, reaching only a fraction of high-income U.S. consumers. The company would continue to face limited market reach, high operational costs, and challenges in educating consumers at scale.

Pros:

- Protects product authenticity and quality: By staying small and selective, AB can maintain strict standards, work with top regional producers, and preserve the cultural authenticity that defines the brand.
- Strengthens cultural credibility: Continuing with chef training, tastings, and the Parma Culinary Center reinforces AB's identity as the authoritative ambassador of true Italian gastronomy.
- Minimizes operational risk: Avoiding aggressive expansion prevents overextending the supply chain, reducing the risk of quality lapses, inconsistent sourcing, or brand dilution.
- Maintains exclusivity and premium positioning: Limited distribution in gourmet stores and upscale restaurants supports a luxury image, which is essential for a brand built on heritage.

Cons

- Very limited market reach: Remaining niche means the brand continues to miss the broader high-income U.S. consumer base, reinforcing the issue that Academia is not reaching enough of its intended audience.
- Education remains unscalable: High-touch chef demos, tastings, and classes cannot be expanded quickly or cost-effectively, preventing widespread consumer understanding of authentic Italian products.
- High operating costs: Artisanal sourcing, specialized staff, PR efforts, and running the Parma Culinary Center are expensive, while revenues remain comparatively small.
- Slow or no revenue growth: The current model caps growth potential, leaving AB underscaled.

Weighted Average: 2.9/5

Rating Breakdown:



Market Reach & Scalability

2/5



Consumer Education Effectiveness

3/5



Cost & Operational Complexity

4/5



Brand Image Elevation

4/5



Long-Term Profitability

2/5



Differentiation & Competitive Advantage

3/5

Explanation

The Status Quo scores low because it does not expand AB's market reach and continues to rely on slow, chef-driven, in-person education. While it preserves brand image and keeps costs low, it fails to address the core issue of scaling consumer reach. Its limited footprint results in weak profitability and low differentiation compared to more ambitious alternatives.

In Industry - Alternative 2

There are two parts to the in-industry strategy. The short-term, in-industry strategy for AB is to dedicate a month as “Authentic Italian Month” in Whole Foods, where they advertise their goods and shelve them together to build brand recognition. Hosting Italian Month once or twice a year allows AB products to be merchandised together as a whole, preventing them from being dispersed across the store. Authentic Italian Month will be supported with tastings, regional maps, chef videos, QR-coded recipe cards, and pre-sliced Parma ham samples that bypass deli staff training gaps. This creates a high-visibility retail burst targeted at Whole Foods shoppers, who closely match AB’s premium, ingredient-focused segment. At the same time, attending major culinary festivals such as the NYC Wine & Food Festival provides tasting-driven exposure that significantly boosts consumer understanding and demand. This festival in New York aligns with their pasta factory opening in Avon, New York, which can help meet the demand increase following the exposure. This festival attracts high-income, authenticity-oriented consumers AB seeks but struggles to reach. By connecting festival experiences with retail discovery through QR codes linking to store locators and recipes used in festival tastings, AB can generate immediate trial, build brand awareness quickly, and reinforce its premium positioning without sacrificing authenticity or quality.

The long-term in-industry strategy includes getting their chefs and current restaurants to participate in advertising. AB already sells to many restaurants, and these chefs already use AB’s oils, cheeses, prosciutto, and vinegars in their dishes. AB can invite existing restaurant partners to mention AB explicitly on their menus (e.g., “Made with AB DOP Olive Oil”), talk about the ingredients used, and display small table cards such as “Our prosciutto is authentic Parma ham from AB.” In addition, if customers enjoyed their dish, restaurants can invite them to purchase some of the ingredients that are in stock at the restaurant. Part two of this long-term strategy includes selling high-end meal kits of AB’s ingredients. Each meal kit includes recipe cards explaining the origin and DOP status, as well as step-by-step recipes that customers can follow to make the meal using the pre-portioned ingredients in the box. This directly engages consumers with AB’s ingredients and ensures customers can use their products correctly. The final part of the long-term strategy is to engage in celebrity chef collaborations. There will be exclusive, limited-time menus such as “A Taste of Emilia-Romagna with AB.” Trained chefs will prepare the food customers order and demonstrate how to use the ingredients to encourage diners to buy them. They will also explain where AB sells its products and have some available in the restaurant. This is effective because diners may trust chefs more than brands, making AB the “standard” of authentic Italian ingredients.

Together, these short term and long term in-industry strategies directly target AB’s core challenges. First, this significantly expand access to high-income U.S. consumers across every premium channel: chefs introduce AB’s ingredients to diners, food festivals reach food lovers, Whole Foods connect with wealthy grocery shoppers, and premium meal kits place AB products directly into the homes. Over time, this will evolve AB from a niche import label into the recognized name for authentic Italian ingredients in the U.S.

Pros

- Strong alignment with target consumers: Whole Foods, food festivals, meal kits, and luxury restaurants all attract high-income, authenticity-seeking consumers, which is the target audience AB wants to reach.
- Scalable education without compromising authenticity: Meal kits and chef explanations teach consumers how to use oils, cheeses, and vinegars at home, solving the education barrier in a cost-effective and repeatable way.
- Uses existing chef relationships rather than building new networks: With restaurants already using AB ingredients, the brand can leverage existing resources to spread messages at a low cost.
- Builds both immediate trial (festivals) and long-term brand authority (chef endorsements): Premium food festivals provide quick awareness and tasting-driven conversion, while luxury restaurant collaborations build an authentic reputation over time.

Cons

- Still dependent on intermediaries (chefs, retailers, meal-kit companies): AB continues relying on third parties to communicate its value story, which limits direct control over messaging and consumer experiences.
- High cost and labour intensity for festivals and chef collaborations: Premium festivals, menu partnerships, and culinary events require sampling, staffing, travel, and product costs—costs that may constrain scalability.
- Risk of inconsistent execution by chefs, servers, and retail staff: Even if chefs agree to mention AB on menus, quality of explanation varies; servers may not communicate ingredient stories clearly, weakening the educational impact.
- Slow pace of long-term impact: Chef-driven credibility and meal-kit familiarity build brand authority gradually; despite being effective, these approaches may take years to shift AB from niche to scaled presence.

Weighted Average: 3.7/5

Rating Breakdown:



Market Reach & Scalability

4/5



Consumer Education Effectiveness

4/5



Cost & Operational Complexity

2/5



Brand Image Elevation

4/5



Long-Term Profitability

4/5



Differentiation & Competitive Advantage

4/5

Explanation

The in-Industry strategy performs well because it increases exposure through Whole Foods, chefs, festivals, and meal kits, which are all channels that target high-income consumers. It also improves education through tastings and chef explanations, though these methods remain resource-intensive and less scalable. Operational complexity and cost pull down the score.

Out of Industry - Alternative 3

An out-of-industry strategy for AB is to partner with The Great Courses to create a digital education course that teaches high-income consumers the foundations of authentic Italian gastronomy. The Great Courses platform is chosen because in 2006, it is a widely used platform that offer premium, professor-led, in-depth academic learning that customers are willing to pay for as a complete, high-quality course. Through a dedicated AB The Great Courses page, the brand can offer expert-led classes on olive oil tasting, pairing cheeses and cured meats, mastering regional Italian dishes, and understanding DOP certifications, areas where consumers currently lack knowledge. AB will invite current chefs to do video demonstrations and explanations and also record lectures held in the Culinary Center in Parma. By producing structured video modules, downloadable tasting guides, and chef-demonstration lessons, AB can deliver its education at large and accessible scale. The Great Courses's learner base consists largely of curiosity-driven adults who actively seek detailed educational content, making it a great match for AB's target audience. The course will be sold as a whole, including all modules of the origins and certifications of food, preparation, and tastings. Ultimately, the The Great Courses partnership transforms AB from a niche importer dependent on in-person experiences into a widely accessible educator capable of reaching learners online that can drive brand awareness, knowledge of authentic Italian food, and steps to correctly prepare food that can drive long-term product demand.

To complement this adult-focused strategy, AB will also target younger consumers by integrating its pasta and ingredients into the Cooking Mama video game franchise. Cooking Mama is chosen for its popularity in around 2006 among children, teens, and casual gamers, especially girls and families, who play it as a cute, stress-free game. This partnership will introduce children to the fundamentals of authentic Italian cooking through playful, step-by-step mini-games that mirror real AB processes, selecting DOP-certified pasta, chopping onions, grating Parmigiano Reggiano, and simmering tomato sauce. By gamifying the preparation of high-quality Italian dishes, AB builds early brand familiarity with children for premium pasta. This child-focused educational pathway plants long-term loyalty by making authentic Italian cuisine fun, accessible, and memorable from a young age. Making Italian food using AB ingredients, such as pasta, will be a dedicated game module that players unlock using points. AB will pay to place this module as the second unlockable module, ensuring it becomes the first cuisine players unlock, giving it higher exposure than later modules. Within each step of the pasta-making process, the game character will guide players through the steps to properly cook pasta. Players will begin with simple pasta dishes, and as they progress and level up, they can unlock more authentic Italian ingredients sold by AB, such as olive oil, vinegar, sauces, cured meats, and cheeses that can be used in the dishes. Together, the The Great Courses for adults and the Cooking Mama for the younger demographics create a full education system that strengthens AB's cultural footprint across generations while driving future demand for its authentic Italian products.

Pros

The Great Courses:

- Massive reach to high-income consumers: Platforms like The Great Courses attract professionals who are curious, educated, and willing to pay for premium learning, who are AB's target demographic.
- Scalable, repeatable education: Unlike relying on chefs or in-store demos, digital courses and games allow AB to teach consumers about DOP certifications, tasting methods, and Italian cuisine at large scale.
- Alignment with AB's brand identity: AB is positioned as an educator and cultural ambassador; teaching through structured culinary modules strengthens this positioning and enhances credibility.
- High marketing efficiency: One course can reach millions without recurring costs for staff demos, festivals, or retail educators, making it a cost-effective long-term investment.

Cooking Mama Game:

- Builds lifelong brand familiarity: By exposing children to AB ingredients early, the brand becomes emotionally familiar, increasing the chance they will choose AB as adults.
- Multi-generational educational ecosystem: Adults learn authentic Italian cooking techniques through The Great Courses, while kids learn through games—together creating a strong cultural presence that few food brands achieve.
- Strengthens authenticity messaging: The mini-games reinforce AB's DOP-certified ingredients, proper technique, artisanal quality. Kids learn "the right way" to cook pasta, forming perceptions that AB = real Italian food.

Cons

The Great Courses:

- High upfront production and partnership costs: Premium platforms require significant investment for high-quality video production, platform fees, and potentially co-branded contracts.
- No guaranteed product conversion: Consumers may enjoy learning without necessarily buying AB products, as conversion depends on strong integration (QR codes, links, bundles).
- Requires sophisticated storytelling and instructor talent: AB must rely on charismatic chefs or experts who can deliver compelling content.
- Risk of brand dilution if not executed well: If the content is too generic, too technical, or inconsistent with AB's premium image, it may weaken the brand rather than elevate it.

Cooking Mama Game:

- Risk of being perceived as overly commercial: Parents may feel the game is being used to advertise food products to kids, which could trigger negative sentiment around brand ethics.
- Complexity of managing two very different channels: Running premium adult educational content + child-focused gaming requires different messaging, partners, and budgets, creating difficulty
- Potential mismatch between AB's upscale image and casual gaming: Cooking Mama is cute, playful, and inexpensive, which is very different from AB's luxury, gourmet positioning. The brand must ensure the integration doesn't dilute its premium identity.

Weighted Average: 4.1/5

Rating Breakdown:



Market Reach & Scalability

4/5



Consumer Education Effectiveness

4/5



Cost & Operational Complexity

4/5



Brand Image Elevation

4/5



Long-Term Profitability

4/5



Differentiation & Competitive Advantage

5/5

Explanation

The Out-of-Industry strategy scores the highest because it offers unmatched scalability, reaching millions of affluent learners through digital education platforms. It simultaneously solves the consumer education gap and elevates brand prestige by positioning AB as a cultural authority. With relatively low operational costs and strong differentiation, it outperforms the other strategies across nearly all weighted criteria.

05 Recommendation

	Status Quo	In Industry	Out of Industry
Weighted Average	2.9/5	3.7/5	4.1/5

Summary

We recommend choosing the out-of-Industry strategy, specifically the The Great Courses digital education partnership and the Cooking Mama Game, because it most effectively resolves AB's core challenges of scale, reach, and consumer education. Unlike chef-driven events or retail channels, which are costly, fragmented, and limited to small groups, The Great Courses enables AB to teach many high-income, food-curious consumers at once, directly targeting the demographic the brand has struggled to reach. The Cooking Mama Game directly educates children to familiarize them with the process and ingredients of AB. This approach not only delivers the most scalable and consistent form of education but also creates generational recognition and trust for AB's products. With strong market reach, low operational complexity, high brand-building potential, and long-term profitability, the out of industry strategy is the most suitable and impactful path.

06 Action Plan

Months 1–4: Foundation + Content Development

The Great Courses (Adult Strategy)

- Conduct feasibility study + benchmarking of food-related The Great Courses/MasterClass courses.
- Finalize partnership terms with The Great Courses (licensing, revenue share, branding rules, promotion).
- Identify core educational themes:
  - Olive oil tasting
  - DOP certifications
  - Italian regional gastronomy
  - Cheese & cured meat pairing
  - Using AB ingredients in everyday cooking
- Select 2–3 AB chefs as on-screen instructors.
- Create curriculum outlines for 5–7 premium courses (20–55 minutes).
- Draft scripts, tasting guides, storyboards, and regional visuals.
- Decide on pricing strategy.
- Film pilot content + design downloadable guides (maps, tasting sheets, ingredient charts).

Cooking Mama (Children Strategy)

- Conduct feasibility review of integrating AB pasta into Cooking Mama recipes.
- Initiate licensing discussions with Cooking Mama LTD (ingredients usage, branding, exclusive recipes).
- Define key educational elements for children:
  - Identifying and preparing ingredients
  - Cooking steps for authentic Italian pasta
- Provide AB's ingredient images, textures, and preparation methods to game artists.
- Prototype for the game is drafted.

Months 5–9: Production + Launch Preparation

The Great Courses (Adult Strategy)

- Film full course modules at AB's Culinary Center in Parma.
- Record voiceovers, tasting walkthroughs, and chef-led demonstrations.
- Edit and upload videos to The Great Courses standards (subtitles, course descriptions, instructor profiles).
- Integrate downloadable PDFs, QR codes, and links to retailers (Whole Foods).
- Implement Search Engine Optimization tagging for premium learners ("Italian Cooking," "Olive Oil Tasting").
- Develop cross-channel promotional plan:
  - Instagram teasers
  - Chef highlights
  - Behind-the-scenes clips
  - Press outreach

Cooking Mama (Children Strategy)

- Have AB's most popular pasta recipe fully developed and integrated into Cooking Mama
- Add AB branding into UI elements (ingredient splash screens, packaging icons).
- Designing the following game phases (using more AB ingredients) that players can unlock after the first phase of pasta making.
- Conduct internal playtesting with kids (8–14) to ensure fun + educational clarity.

Months 10–13: Official Launch + Awareness Building

The Great Courses (Adult Strategy)

- Officially launch the courses
- Release the first 3–4 The Great Courses courses with coordinated global promotion.
- Host livestream Q&A: “How to Taste Authentic Olive Oil.”
- Run launch marketing across AB + The Great Courses newsletters and channels.
- Add QR codes on AB products linking to course previews.
- Track initial performance and reviews of the course provided.

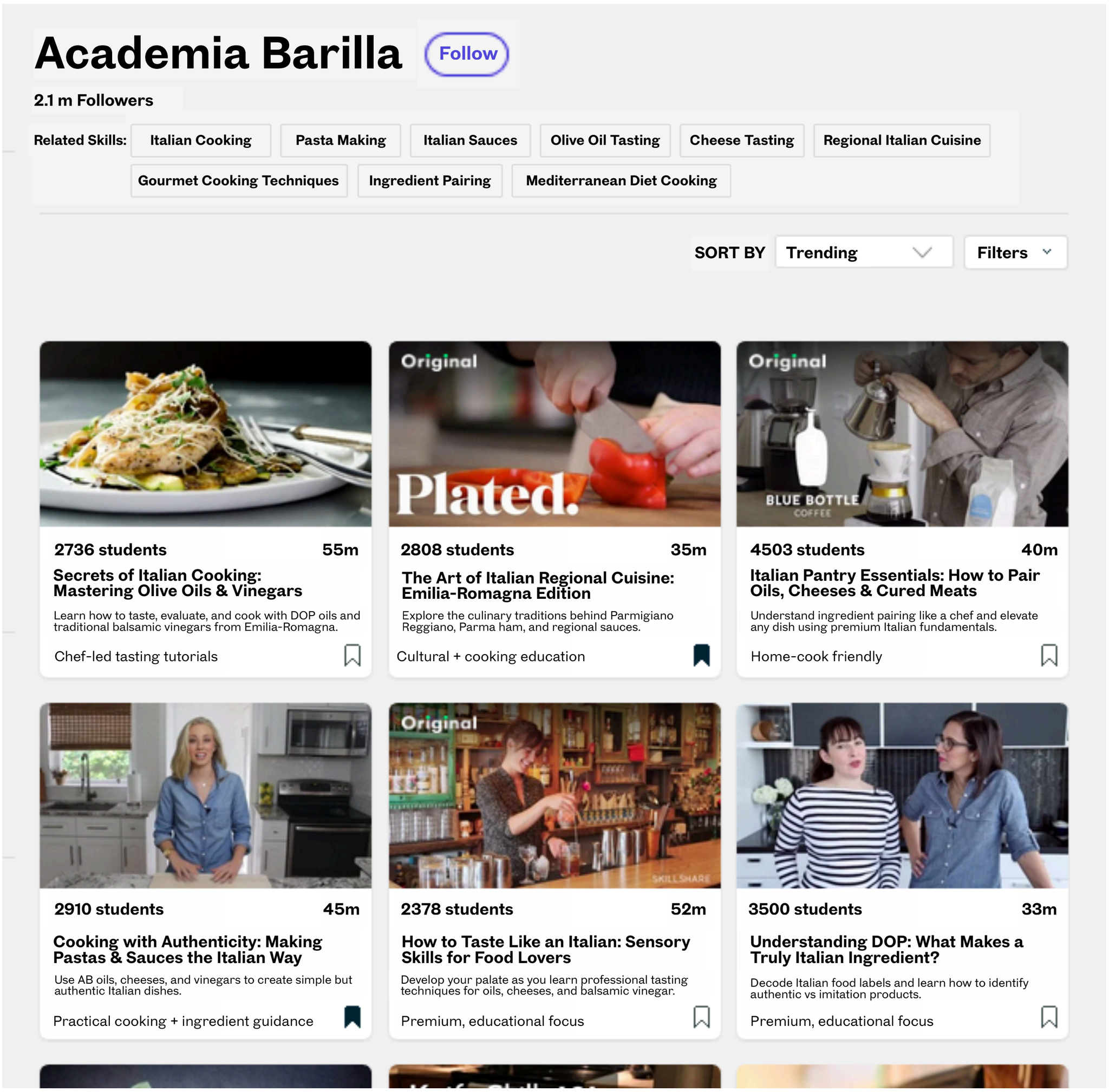
Cooking Mama (Children Strategy)

- Launch the updated app
- Promote through Cooking Mama’s in-game notifications + social channels.
- Release AB-branded recipe challenges (speed, accuracy mode).
- Add “Learn more!” button linking parents to AB’s educational content.
- Program accuracy scoring (to teach correct cooking technique):
  - Chop size accuracy
  - Cheese grating consistency
  - Proper pasta boiling timing
- Distribute promotional codes for AB products through the Cooking Mama community.

Below are detailed prototypes of both the The Great Courses launch and the Cooking Mama collaboration.

The Great Courses Launch Prototype

Below is a sample prototype illustrating how the AB page would appear on The Great Courses.



Cooking Mama Collaboration Prototype

Below is a sample prototype illustrating the gameplay flow. Players will follow interactive steps that mimic the actual motions of preparing each ingredient then cooking pasta. The screens below are prototype screens of the game.

1. Users see a table with all the ingredients.

2. Users will be guided to click on each ingredient and read details about it.



4. To build the flavour base, users add 2 spoons of oil to a pan. When warm, add onion.

5. Users will add meat to the pan and add salt. Cook until the meat changes colour.

6. Users will add tomato sauce and simmer.

7. Boil the pasta in the water.

8.Transfer the pasta onto a plate. Then add the sauce and cheese to the pasta.



Months 14–18: Expansion + Optimization

The Great Courses (Adult Strategy)

- Release 2–3 advanced Italian culinary courses:
  - Deep Dive into Emilia-Romagna Cuisine
  - Professional Tasting Techniques for Cheese & Balsamic
  - Premium Italian Cooking for Home Cooks
- Analyze The Great Courses engagement data (watch time, downloads, drop-off points).
- Optimize lesson pacing and level of difficulty based on analytics.
- Introduce premium AB tasting kits bundled with The Great Courses sign-ups.
- Incorporate The Great Courses content into AB's website, email campaigns, and retail events.
- Long-term goal: AB becomes a recognized premium digital culinary educator.

Cooking Mama (Children Strategy)

- Release additional AB-themed recipes:
  - "Make Pesto the Italian Way!"
  - "Shape Your Own Fresh Pasta!"
  - "Tomato Sauce Mastery!"
- Add seasonal limited-time AB cooking events to drive ongoing engagement.
- Introduce collectible AB ingredient stickers/badges inside the game.
- Analyze in-game metrics (completion rates, repeat play rates).
- Partner with Cooking Mama for a "Kids Cook Italian Month" challenge event.
- Long-term goal: AB becomes associated with Italian cooking in the minds of millions of children worldwide.